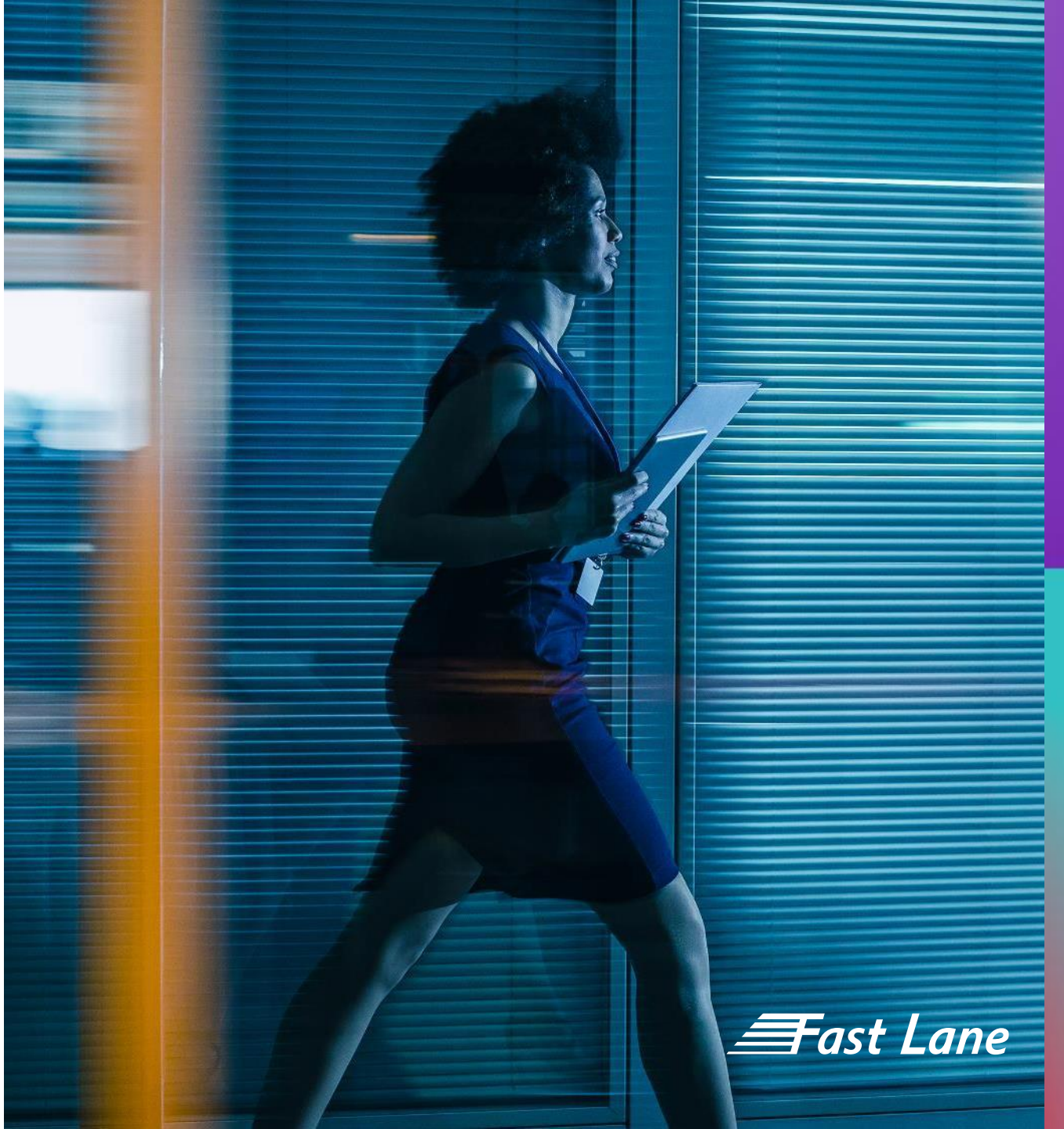
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— AGENTIC AI: FROM STRATEGY TO **PRODUCTION.**

Alexander Kastil

Full stack, from enterprise software to agentic AI. Since 1996

AI at Work
Value discovery, KPI mapping and roadmap

Enterprise AI
Governed multi-agent systems on Microsoft Copilot and Foundry

Agentic Software Engineering
Harness architecture for Claude Code and GitHub Copilot

Team Enablement
AI driven content production and delivery

integrations.at
alexander.kastil@integrations.at

github.com/alexander-kastil
linkedin.com/in/alexander-kastil

INTEGRATIONS

AGENTIC AI CONSULTING · VIENNA



Microsoft CERTIFIED — AGENTIC AI BUSINESS SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT — ★★★

Microsoft CERTIFIED — AZURE AI APP AND AGENT DEVELOPER — ASSOCIATE ★★

Microsoft CERTIFIED — DEVOPS ENGINEER — EXPERT ★★★

SCAN TO CONNECT
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MODULE 1

Introduction to Copilot Cowork & Copilot Studio

The foundation for the whole course

Automate Business Processes with Copilot Studio and Copilot Cowork



01

Agents & Copilots for Microsoft 365

The vocabulary, the ecosystem map and the step to an agent

02

How Agents Work

The agentic loop, the three parts of every agent and the design patterns

03

Agent Harnesses: Choose the Runtime

The four harnesses of Copilot Studio and how to choose one

04

Where to Build and What It Costs

The build paths and how Copilot Credits pay for them

05

Copilot Chat & Productivity Agents

Researcher, Analyst, SharePoint agents and Agent Builder

06

Prepare the Tenant: Licenses & Credits

Optional: the licenses, credit sources and costs behind each module

Introduction to Copilot Cowork and Copilot Studio

The foundation for the whole course

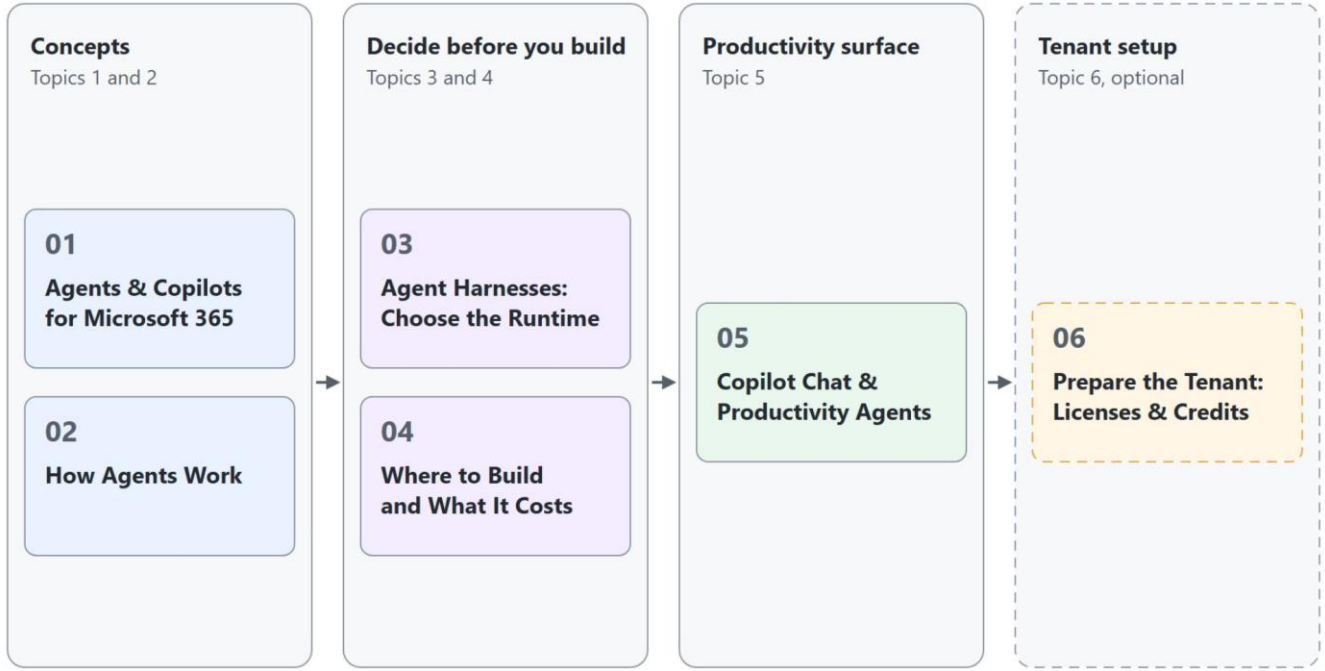
- **Concepts**: what Copilots and agents are, and how every agent works
- **Decide before you build**: the agent harness, the build paths and what Copilot Credits cost
- **Productivity surface**: Copilot Chat, Researcher, Analyst and SharePoint agents



Overview

The path through the six topics

- The vocabulary and **how agents work**: the loop, the agent, the model and the harness
- **Agent harnesses**: the four runtimes in Copilot Studio and how to choose one
- **Where to build**, and how Copilot Credits pay for it
- **Copilot Chat** and the productivity agents that come ready to use
- Optional: **prepare the tenant** with the licenses and credits each module needs



01

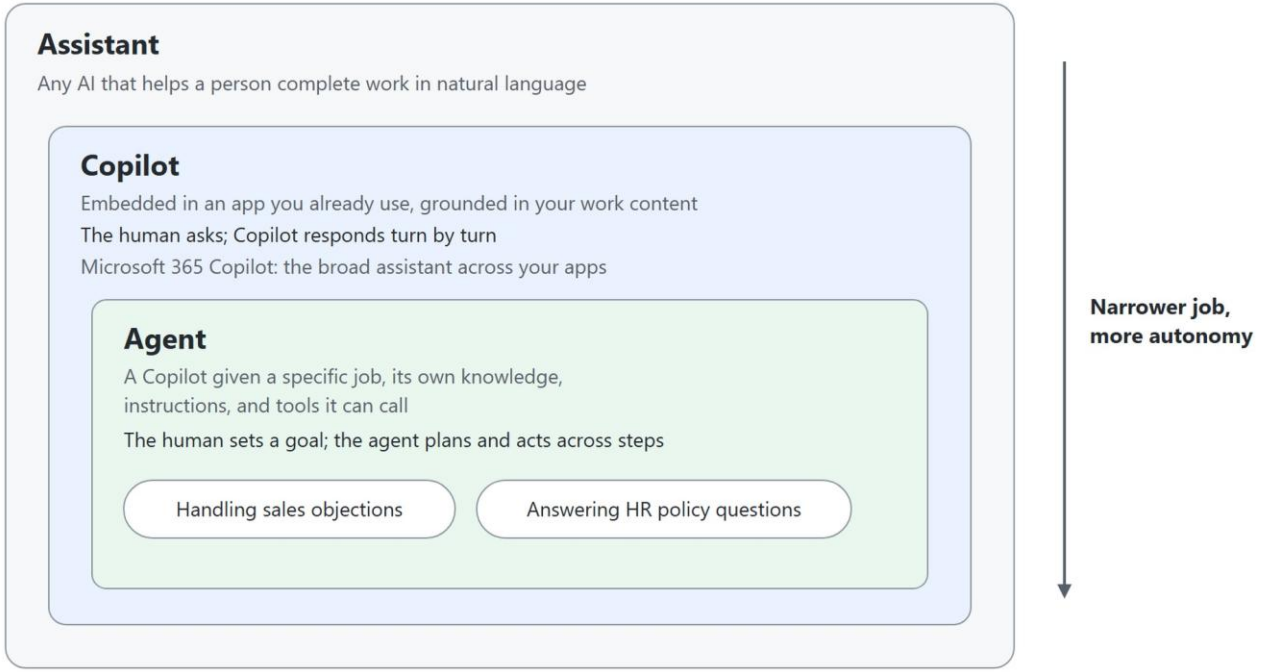
Agents & Copilots for Microsoft 365

The vocabulary, the ecosystem map and the step to an agent

Copilot, agent and assistant

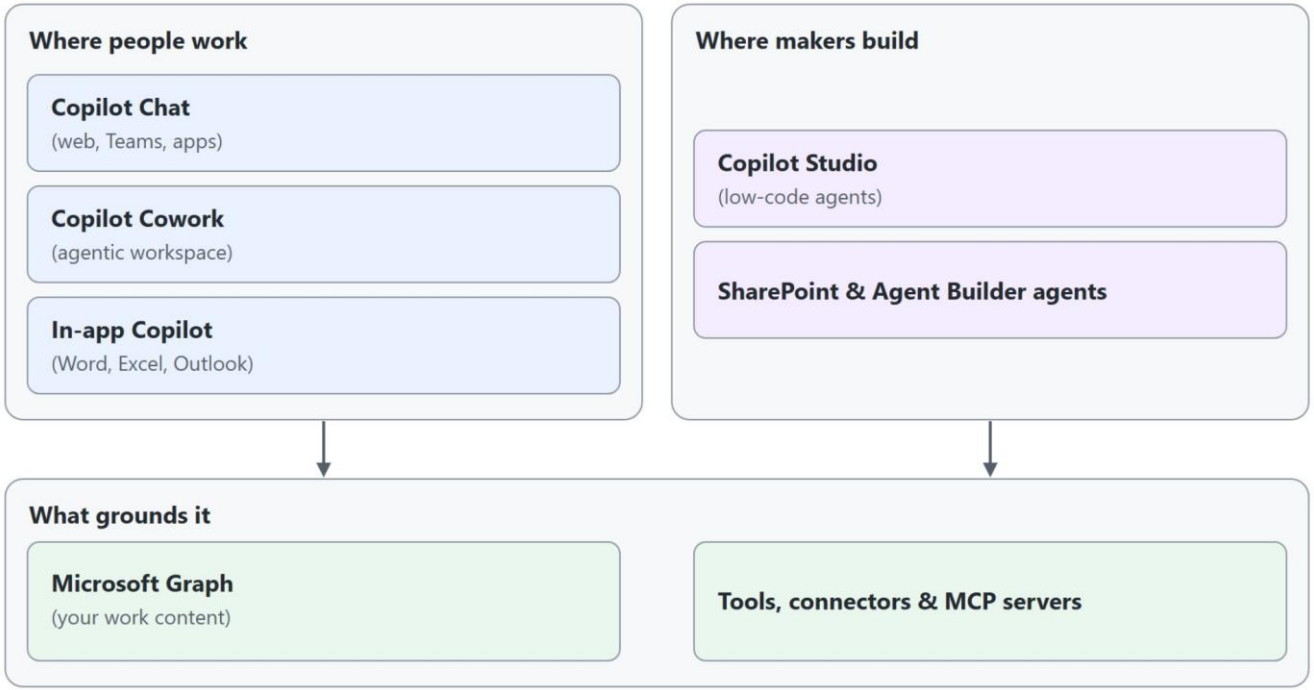
Three terms the course uses with fixed meanings

- **Assistant**: any AI that helps a person complete work in natural language
- **Copilot**: embedded in an app you already use, grounded in your work content
- **Agent**: a Copilot with a specific job, its own knowledge, instructions and tools
- With a Copilot the human asks; with an agent the human **sets a goal**



The Microsoft 365 Copilot ecosystem

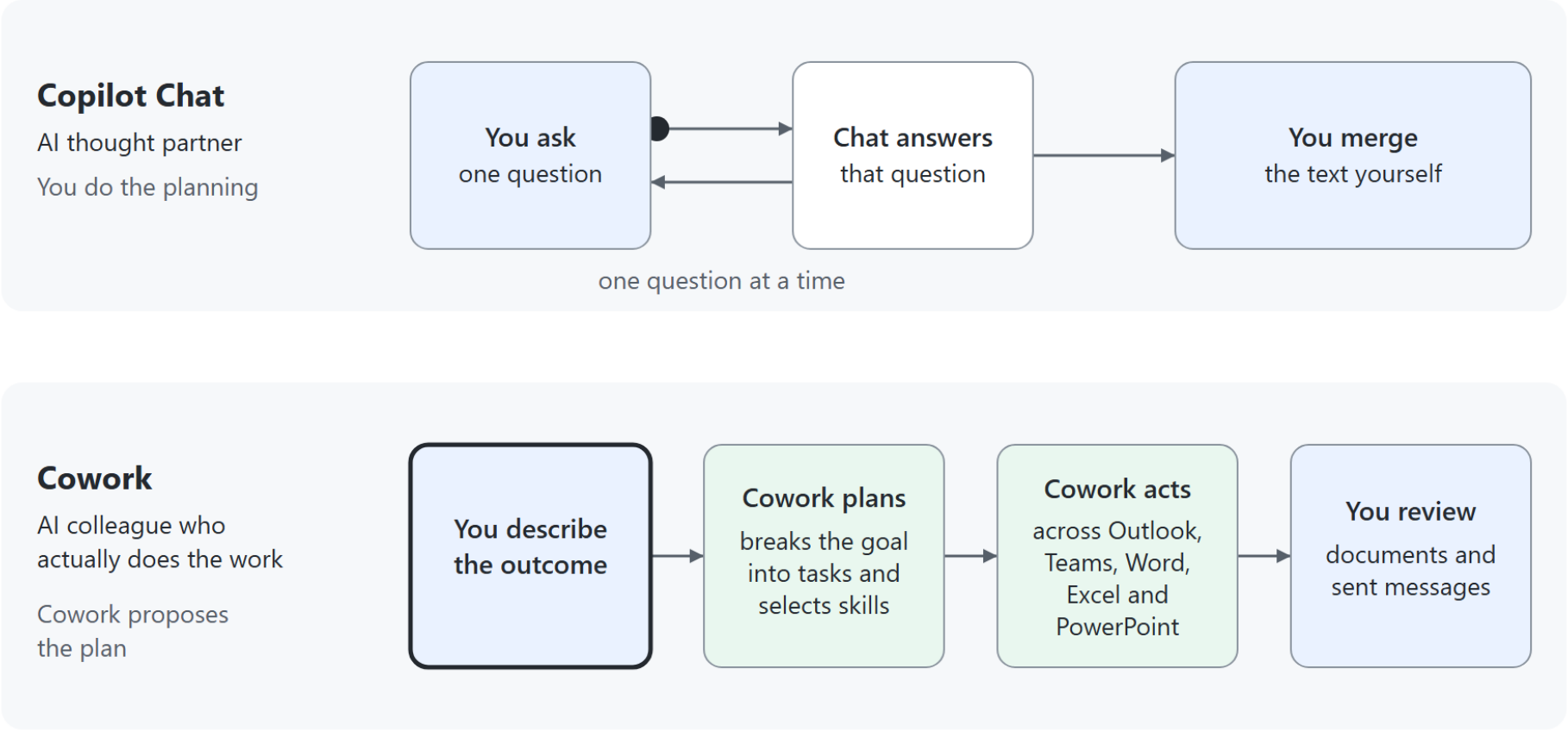
Experiences, build surfaces and the foundation that grounds them



- What people use and what makers build both stand on **Microsoft Graph** and the tools that reach other systems

From Copilot to Cowork

Chat answers your question, Cowork does the work

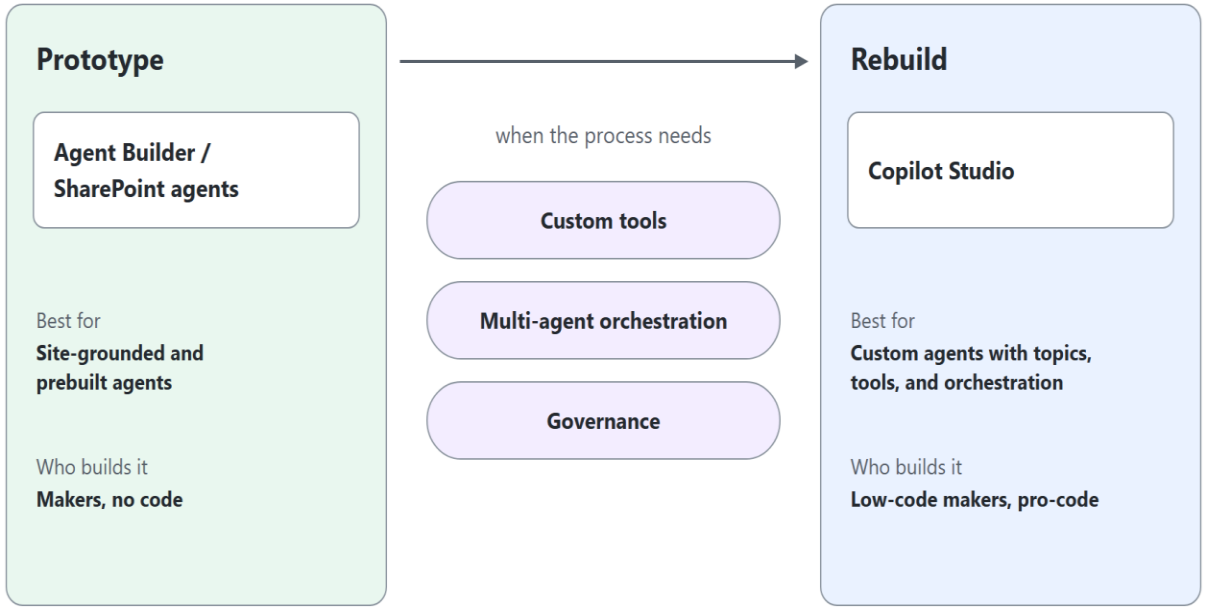


An agent is a Copilot with a **goal**, **tools** and a **loop** until it is met

Start without code, grow into Copilot Studio

Four surfaces, each suited to a different builder

- **Copilot Chat**: everyday drafting and Q&A, nothing to build
- **Copilot Cowork**: recurring knowledge work with skills
- **Agent Builder and SharePoint agents**: makers, no code
- **Copilot Studio**: custom agents with topics, tools and orchestration



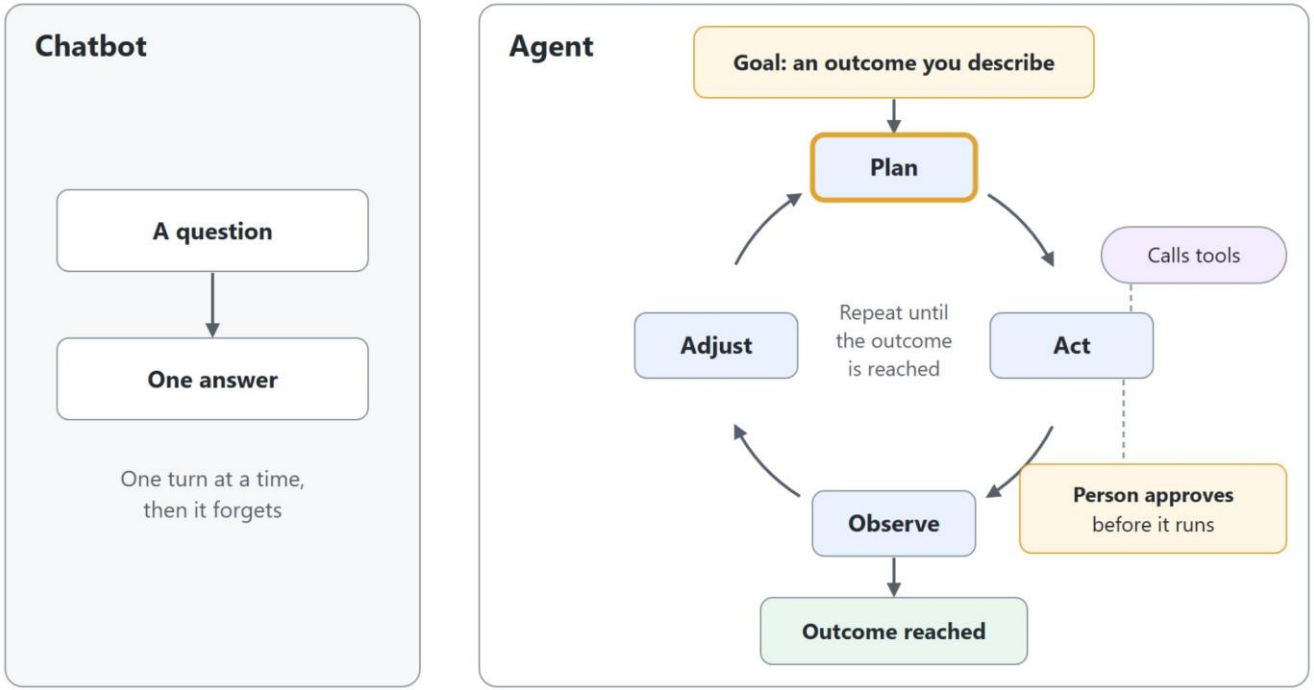
02

How Agents Work

The agentic loop, the three parts of every agent and the design patterns

What makes an AI agentic

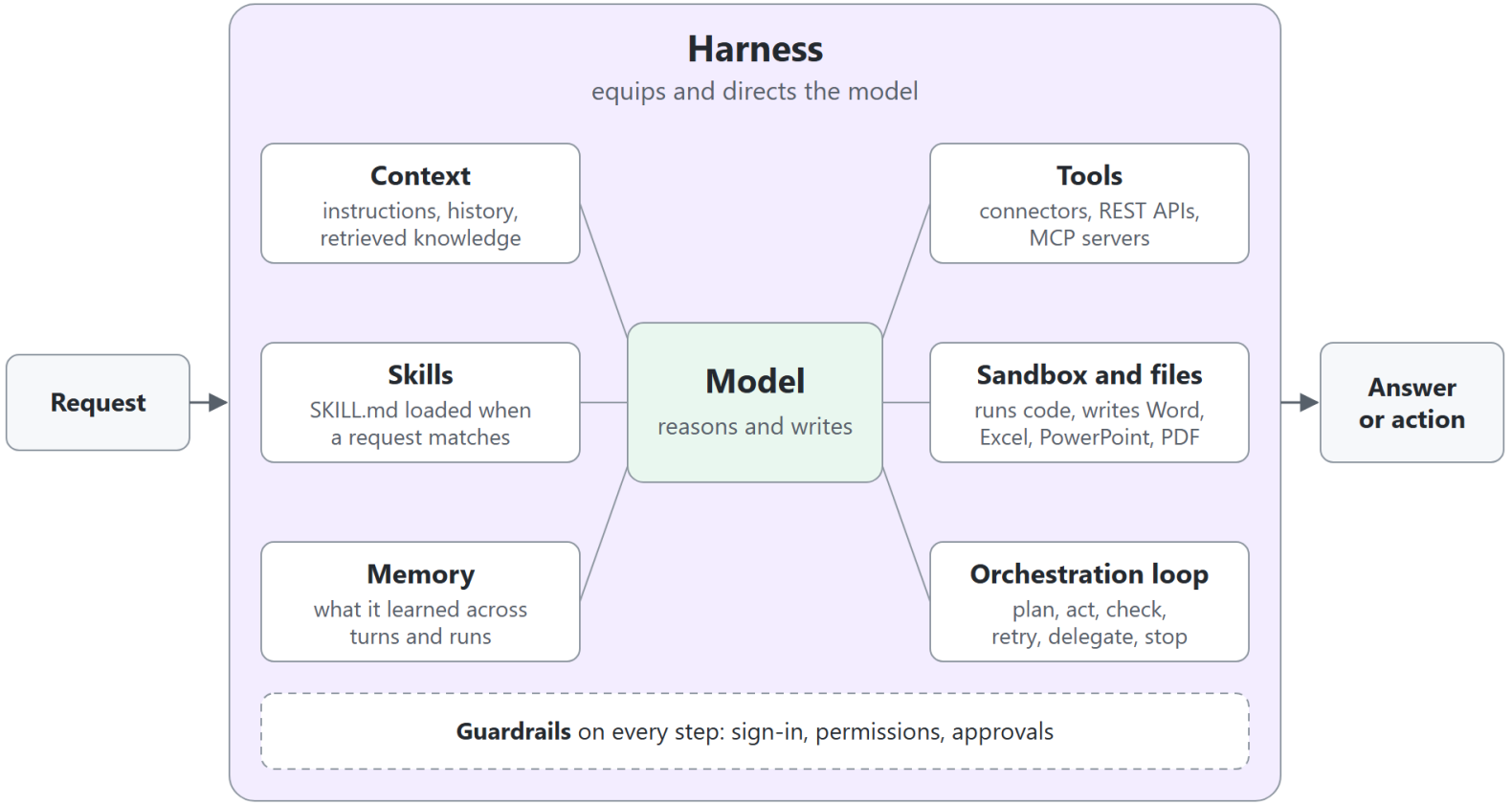
From answering a question to working toward a goal



- A chatbot answers once, while an **agent** plans, acts, observes and adjusts until the goal is reached, and a person approves before an action runs

What a harness is

Everything around the model that turns reasoning into work

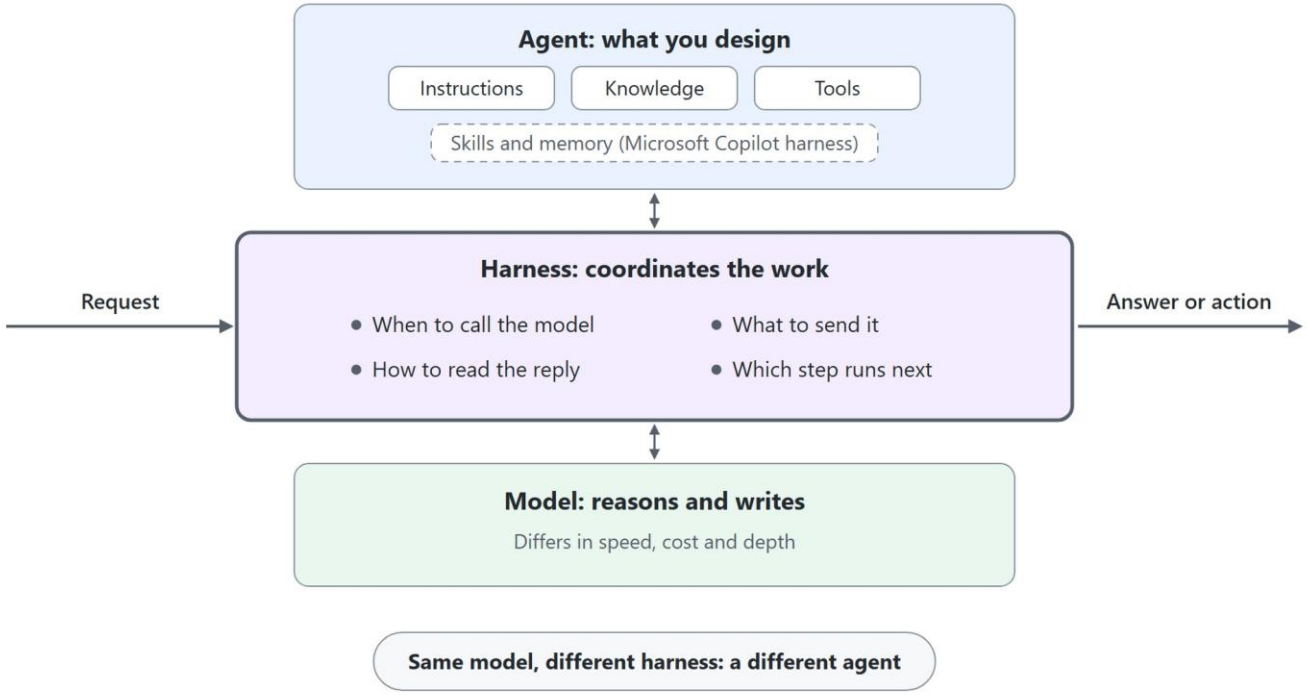


The **model** reasons, the **harness** equips and directs it

Agent, model and harness

What you design, what reasons, what coordinates

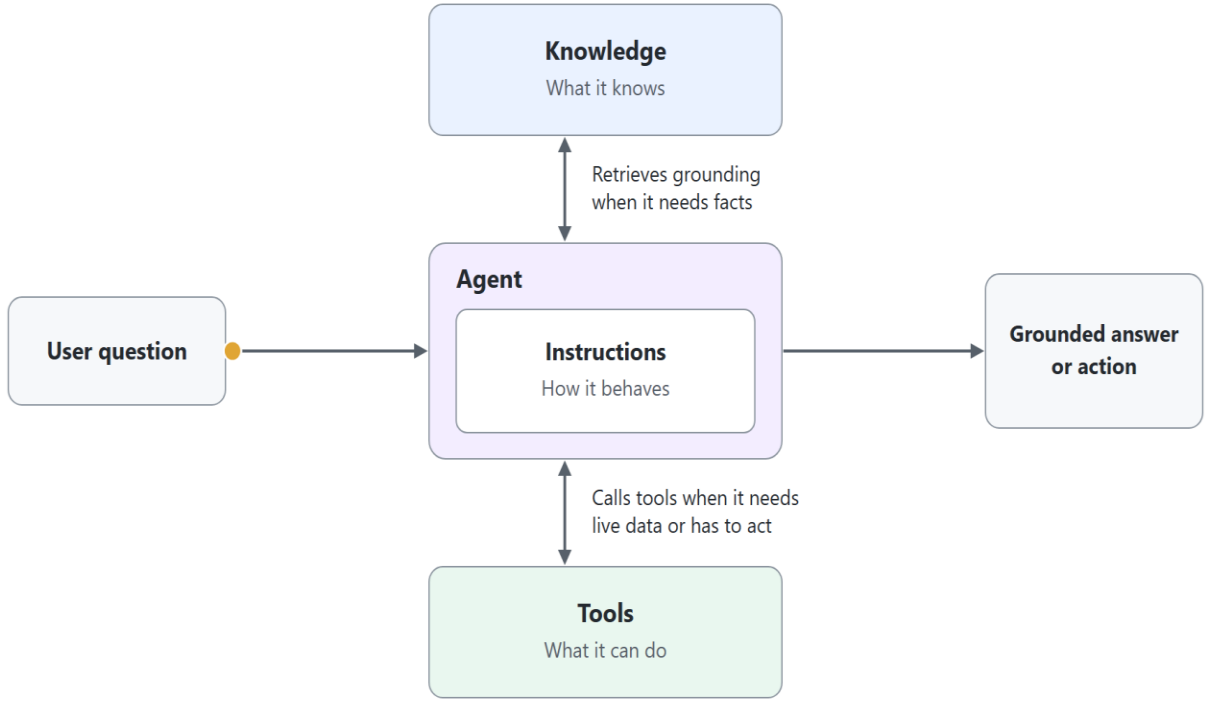
- The **agent** is what you design: instructions, knowledge, tools and boundaries
- The **model** reasons and writes, and models differ in speed, cost and depth
- The **harness** coordinates: when to call the model, what to send, which step runs next
- Same model, different harness: **a different agent**



What you design in every agent

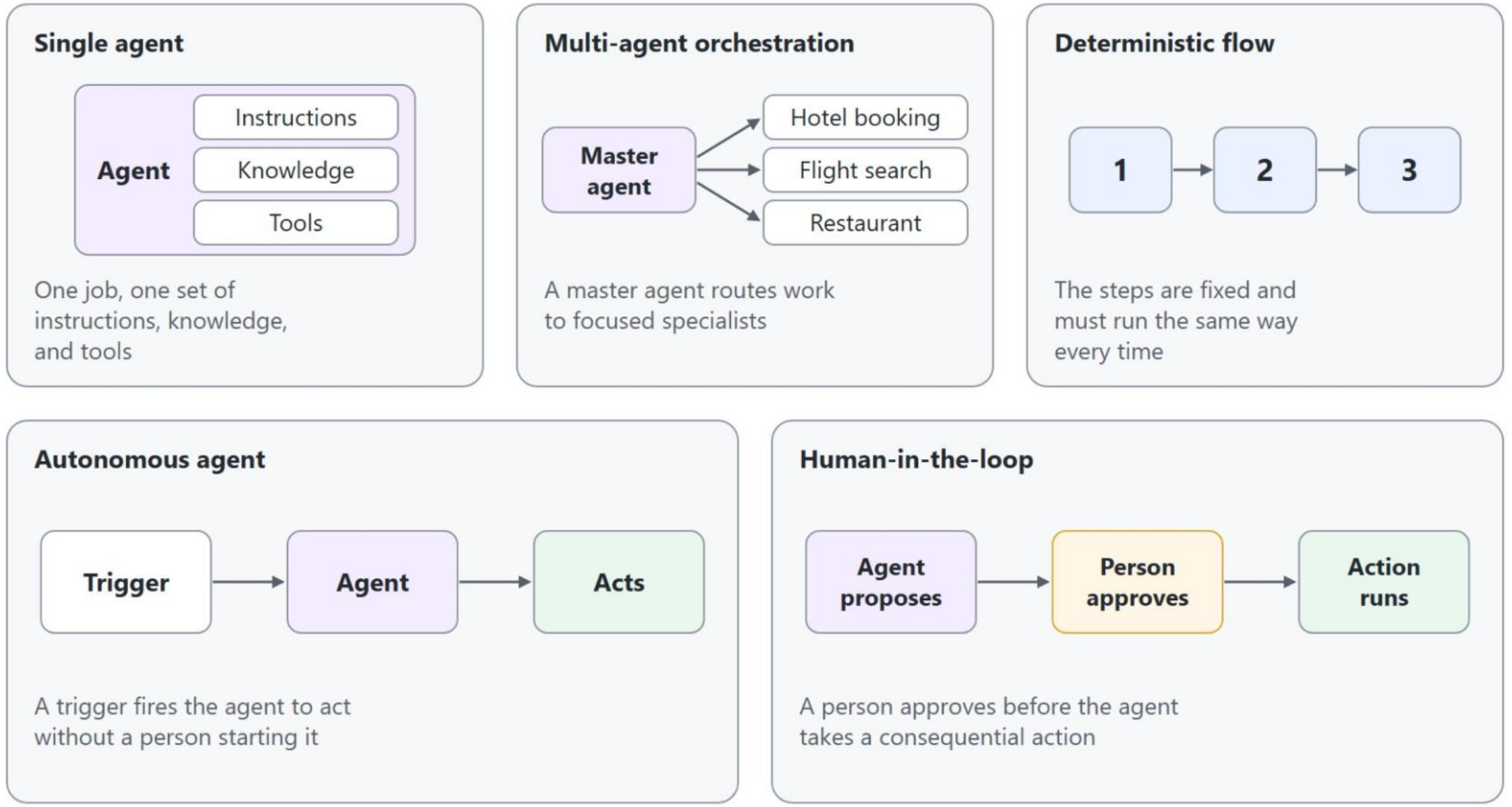
Instructions, knowledge and tools in a Copilot Studio agent

- **Instructions** decide how the agent behaves: role, tone and scope
- **Knowledge** grounds answers in your content when it needs facts
- **Tools** fetch live data or act, often through an MCP server
- A weak agent is thin in one part: **name which one** to fix it



Design patterns in agentic AI

Five patterns to choose and combine



- Choose a **pattern** for the shape of the problem, and combine several in one solution

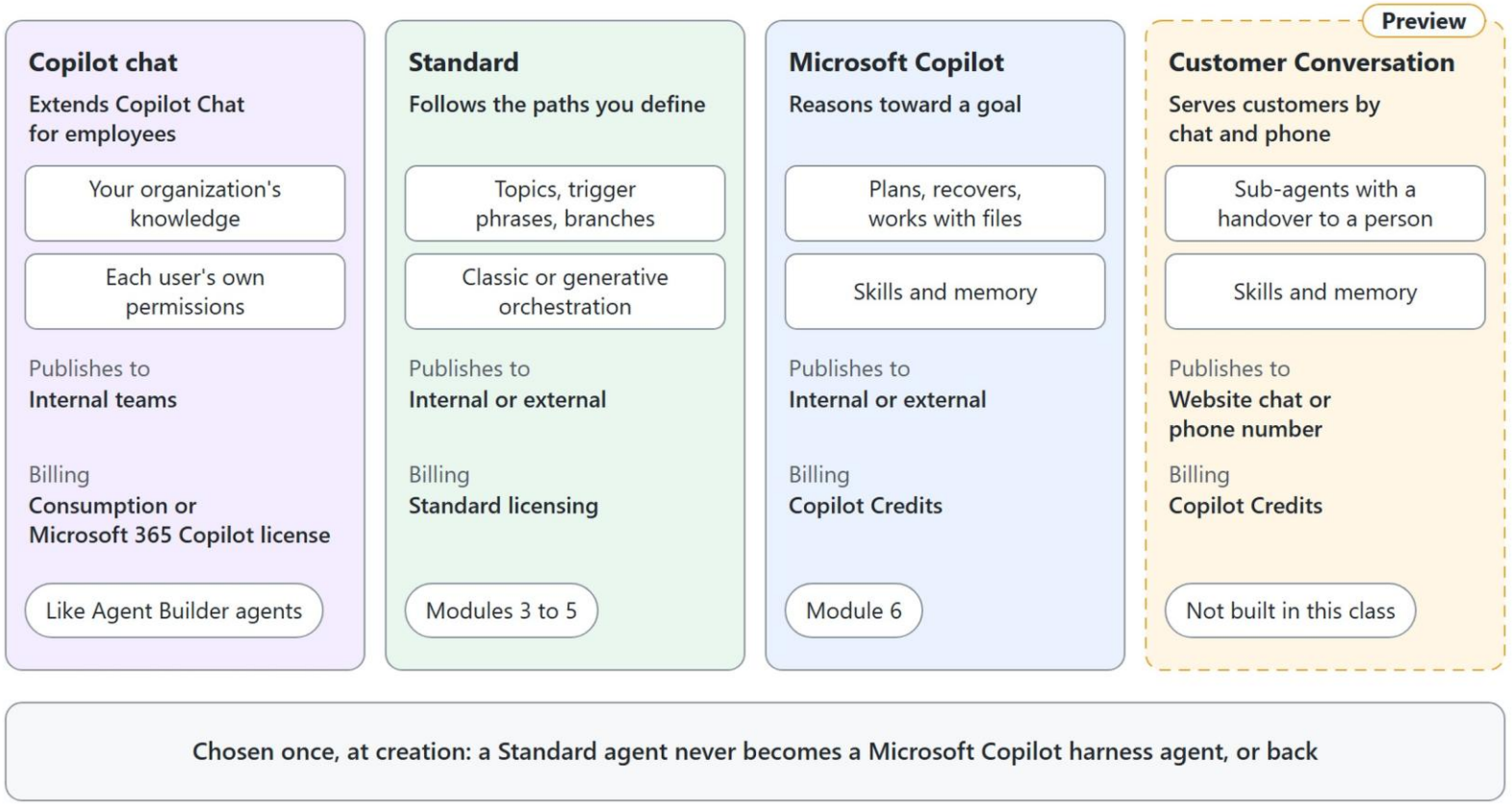
03

Agent Harnesses: Choose the Runtime

The four harnesses of Copilot Studio and how to choose one

Four harnesses in M365

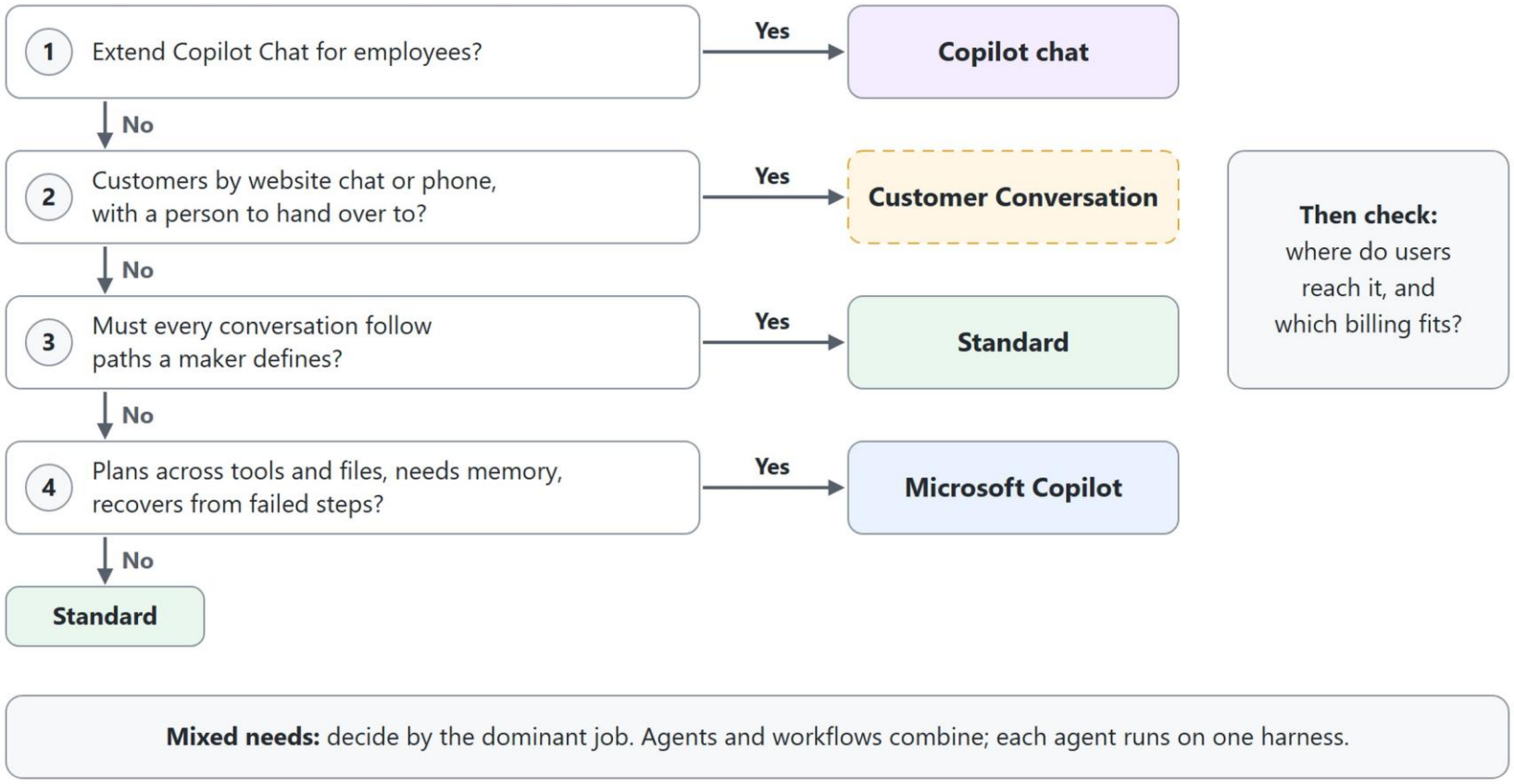
The runtime you pick decides behavior, features and billing



- The harness is chosen **once, at creation**, and fixes behavior, features, publishing and billing

Choose the harness

Answer before you create the agent

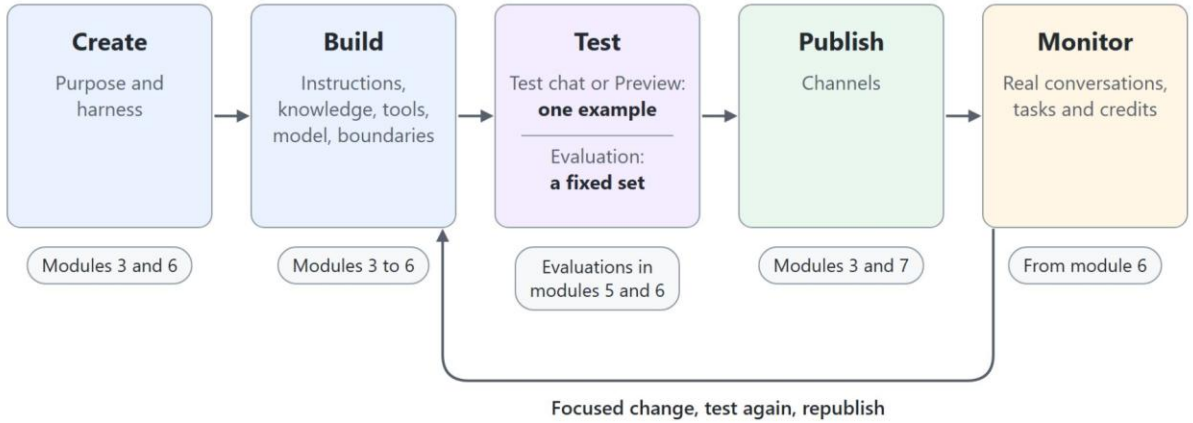


- Walk the questions **top to bottom**; the first Yes names the harness, then check reach and billing

One lifecycle on every harness

Create, build, test, publish, monitor, then improve

- Every agent is **created, built, tested, published and monitored**, whatever harness runs it
- A test chat shows **one example**; an evaluation runs **a fixed set** you can compare
- Monitor shows **real use**, and each finding becomes one focused change
- The tab names differ by harness; **the stages don't**



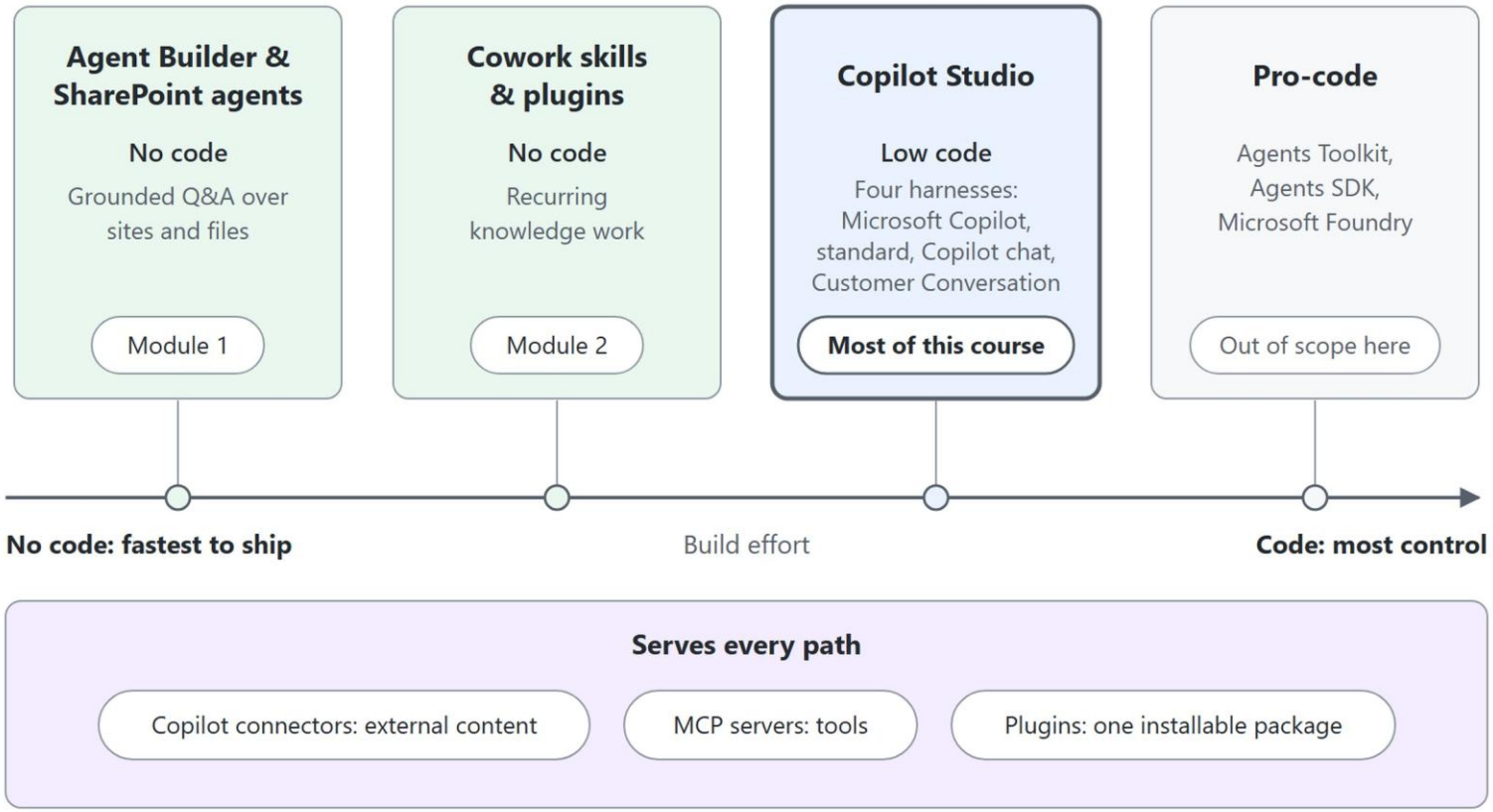
04

Where to Build and What It Costs

The build paths and how Copilot Credits pay for them

Where to build an agent

The lowest-effort path that meets the need

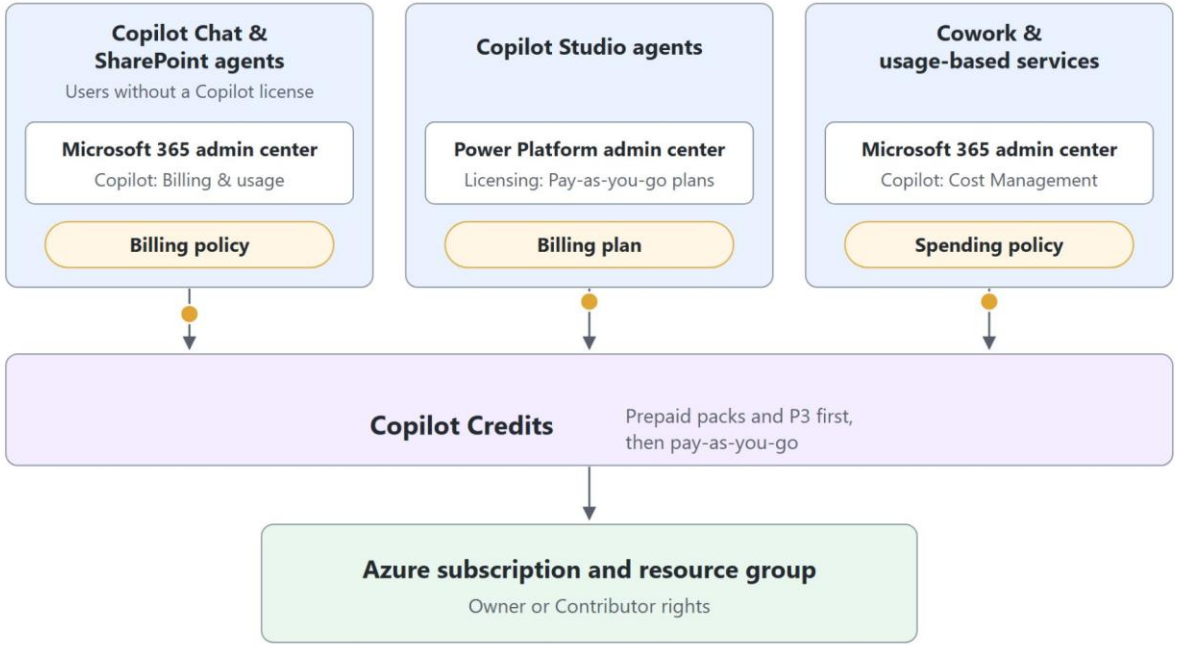


- Start on the **lowest-effort path** that meets the need, and move up when a tool call, a channel or a multi-step process requires it

What agents cost

Copilot Credits and the three billing routes

- **Copilot Credits**: one currency for agent usage since September 2025
- A **Copilot license** zero-rates Copilot Studio agents in Chat, Teams and SharePoint
- **Three routes**: billing policy, billing plan, spending policy
- **Prepaid first**, then pay-as-you-go to one Azure subscription



Spending limits

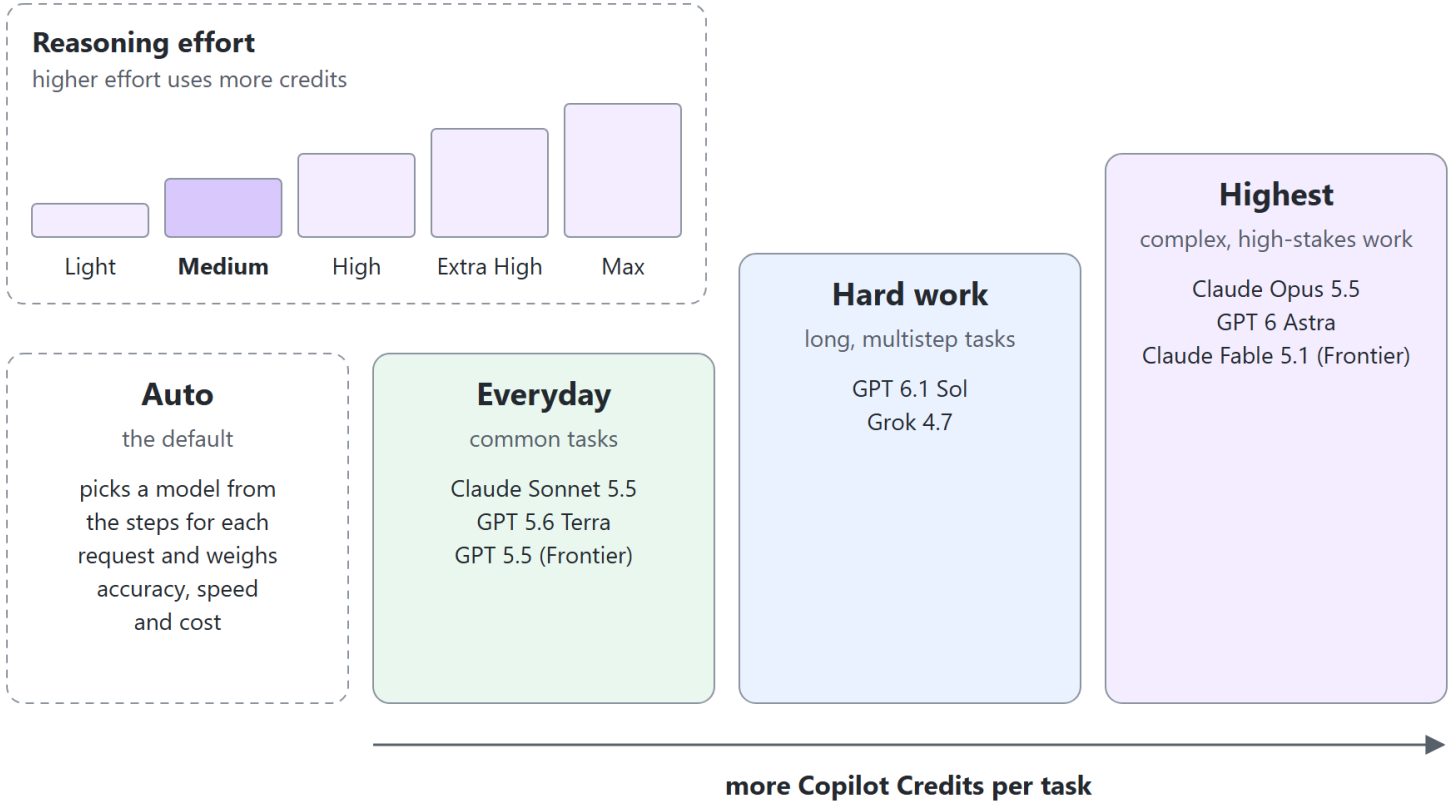
Guardrails set when you activate Copilot Credits

- **Monthly spending limit**: the tenant's total ceiling for the billing period
- **Per-user limit**: the most any one user can consume, at least 2,000 credits a month
- **Alert thresholds** below the ceiling notify you before it is reached
- Set them **at activation**, with numbers from the Copilot Credit Estimator



What the model costs in Cowork

Every task draws Copilot Credits, and the model sets how many



No fixed price per model: **model, effort, context and tools** set a task's credits

05

Copilot Chat & Productivity Agents

Researcher, Analyst, SharePoint agents and Agent Builder

Productivity and SharePoint agents

Ready-to-use agents with nothing to build

- **Researcher**: multi-step research across work content and the web, returned as a source-cited report
- **Analyst**: reasons over your data to produce analysis, tables and charts
- **SharePoint agent**: scoped to a whole site, specific folders or selected documents
- It answers only from what the **person asking** already has permission to see
- Created with **no code**, published to SharePoint and Microsoft 365 Copilot
- **Copilot in OneDrive and SharePoint** works on the files: trends across spreadsheets, folder sorting, interactive HTML reports



Agent Builder

Your own agent in Microsoft 365 Copilot, with no code

- **Describe** the job in plain language, or configure each field by hand or from a template, then test on **Try it**
- **Knowledge**: SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams chats, your email, public sites, uploaded files and Copilot connectors
- **Share** it with people, or submit it to the org catalog for the Agent Store
- **No actions**: copy the agent to Copilot Studio when it needs connectors or workflows



06

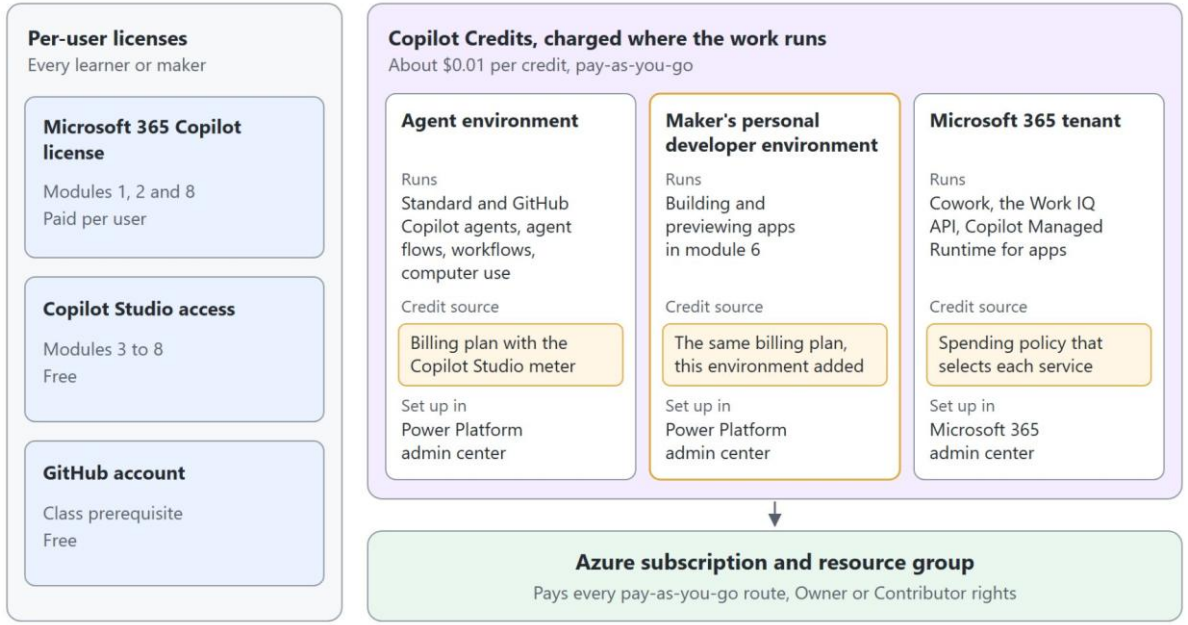
Prepare the Tenant: Licenses & Credits

Optional: the licenses, credit sources and costs behind each module

Licenses and credit sources

Few seats, and credits charged where the work runs

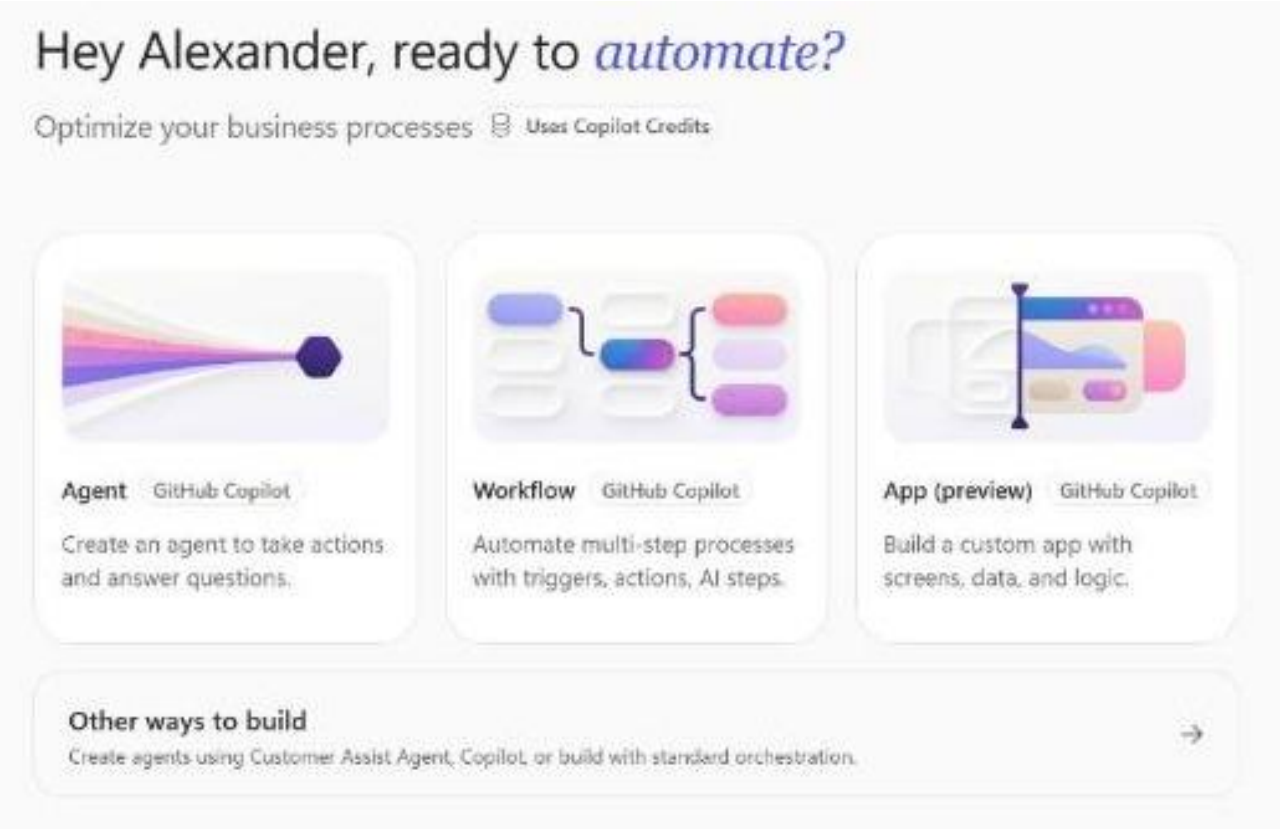
- **Per user**: a Microsoft 365 Copilot license, Copilot Studio access and a GitHub account
- Everything else is **Copilot Credits** or an Azure resource on one subscription
- Credits are charged **where the work runs**: agent environment, developer environment or tenant
- Each maker's **personal developer environment** needs the billing plan too



What a Copilot license covers

The harness decides whether building draws credits

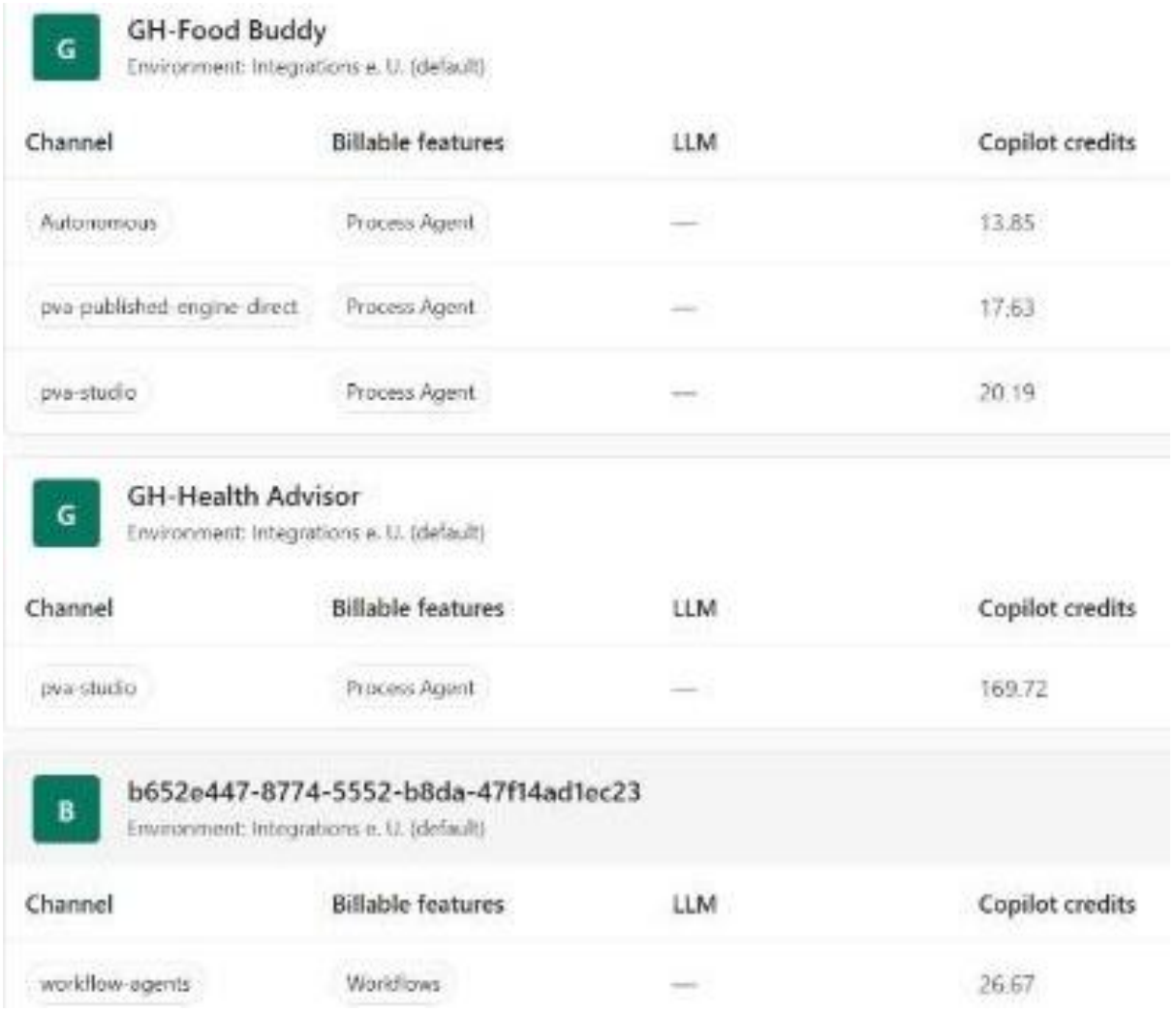
- **Standard agents** run zero-rated for licensed users in Microsoft 365 channels
- Their test chat costs nothing: every Standard agent demo ran at **0 credits**
- **Microsoft Copilot harness agents**, workflows and apps bill from the first build step
- The Copilot Studio home page marks the paths that use **Copilot Credits**



Where a run's cost shows

Billed credits per agent in the Power Platform admin center

- **Manage Agents** lists billed credits per agent, channel and feature
- A Microsoft Copilot harness agent: **169.72 credits** for five Preview sessions
- One workflow run: **26.67 credits** on the workflow-agents channel
- Work IQ API and Cowork costs show only in Microsoft 365 **Cost management**



Takeaways

What to carry into the Cowork module

- Every agent is a Copilot with a **narrower job and more autonomy**
- An agent works toward a **goal** in a loop, and a person approves consequential actions
- Fix a weak agent by naming its thin part: **instructions, knowledge or tools**
- Choose the **harness** before you create the agent: it fixes behavior, features and billing
- Take the **lowest-effort path** that meets the need, and set **Copilot Credit** limits before the first bill

